

Canada

Canada's Competition Bureau

The Digital Enforcement and Intelligence Branch (DEIB) leverage data and technology to support the Competition Bureau of Canada's enforcement and competition promotion initiatives. DEIB functions as a centre of expertise on digital business practices and technologies and provides specialized skills, including a centralized intelligence function. The branch acts as an early-warning system for potential competition issues at all stages, from initial intelligence to post-investigation. It also gathers intelligence from the marketplace and provides insight on how companies may use technology to compete or to harm competition. The Digital Enforcement Directorate provides analysis and advice on the use of data, technology, and digital tools in markets as well as how data analytics and emerging digital solutions can be integrated into the Bureau's enforcement and promotion work. The directorate also houses the Innovation Station, a space that brings branch experts and Bureau employees together to creatively problem-solve. The Intelligence, Behavioural Insights, and Remedies Directorate helps the Bureau find potentially harmful conduct quickly, understand how decisions are made by consumers and businesses, and ensure consistent and effective resolutions when enforcement action is taken.

DEIB's objective is to provide support and expert advice for colleagues across the organization, to make the organization's work more efficient and effective. The Intelligence Unit works together with our digital enforcement team to collect and analyze data and uncover trends that can be identified to support proactive enforcement. They also work together using statistical techniques and computational methods to proactively detect anti-competitive bidding practices in Canadian markets. The Data and Analytics Unit uses advanced analytics and data science to build tools that create efficiencies and add new capabilities to our investigative and promotional work. This includes projects with a focus on automation, for instance using Natural Language Processing (NLP) techniques with other techniques to automatically identify and measure groups of similar documents for investigations. The Technology Insights Unit focuses on understanding evolving business practices and technologies, along with their impact on competition. The team helps identify emerging threats to competition more quickly and provides expertise on new technologies.

Artificial intelligence (AI) has been a priority area for the Competition Bureau. This year it launched a consultation on how AI may affect competition, in the context of Canadian competition law.¹ The consultation paper provides an overview of the markets involved in AI production, from computational and data inputs, development of AI technologies, and the production of AI products and services.

¹ Canada Competition Bureau, *Artificial intelligence and competition*, <https://competition-bureau.canada.ca/how-we-foster-competition/education-and-outreach/artificial-intelligence-and-competition> (last accessed June 8, 2024).